

Method section: Introduction to R

Networks and Innovation Training Programme
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and



- Are going to become your best friends...
- And your worst enemies



But don't pull your hair out just yet... we're here to help

Why for network analysis?

- Cons:
 - R is not the only tool and certainly not the simplest
 - R has a steep learning curve
- Pros:
 - R can do most types of network analysis thanks to user-built libraries (statnet, Rsiena, igraph, tnet)
 - Because R is a programming language, you can customize solutions to your problems
 - The community is growing, which means more *user contributed libraries* and more *support*

Downloading the software

-  can be found at <http://www.r-project.org/>
 - Find the installer for your system (runs on Windows, Mac and Linux)
-  can be found at <http://www.rstudio.com>
 - Here again Windows, Mac and Linux
 - You will want RStudio desktop (not server)
- But of course, you have all installed it already, right?

Finding information and help on R

- [Rseek](#): a layer on top of Google, filtering out results not related to R (created by Sasha Goodman)
- [R-help](#): R mailing list, have a look at the archives too
- [Cross Validated](#): Statistics forum with a lot of R users
- [Stack Overflow](#): for programming oriented questions (use the [r] tag)

A few words of comfort before we dive into R

- Getting up to speed with R is made easier if:
 - You have some programming knowledge (Python, Javascript, C)
 - You have experience with $\text{\LaTeX}$
 - You have used Stata in the past
- If not:

**DON'T
PANIC**

We're here to help

Start RStudio